

MARK S. CRITZ
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COMMITTEE ON SMALL BUSINESS



Congress of the United States
House of Representatives

Washington, DC 20515
January 3, 2012

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The Honorable Ray H. LaHood
Secretary
U. S. Department of Transportation
1200 New Jersey Ave., SE
Washington, DC 20590-0001

Dear Secretary LaHood:

I write to you in support of the Transportation, Community, and System Preservation Program (TCSP) grant application for a 2.5-mile bike/ped segment of the Ohio River Trail in PA.

The Ohio River Trail (ORT) project is part of the Rivers of Steel National Heritage Area, and is located in a metropolis of 27 linked municipalities working to recover economically and environmentally from the decline of the industrial era. The ORT, which includes over 41 miles of proposed shoreline of the Ohio River just downstream from Pittsburgh, has been supported by the Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources (PA-DCNR) through grants for two Feasibility Studies.

While the initial section of the ORT is only 2.5 miles long, it will link existing trail systems from Pittsburgh to Washington DC, following the Montour Rail-Trail, the Great Allegheny Passage, and the C&O Canal Towpath.

This project represents an opportunity to link the midatlantic trail systems in such a way that would catalyze future development throughout the region. Thus, it is with great pleasure that I am afforded the opportunity to provide my support for this project

Thank you for your continued leadership; I urge you to give this application for funding your highest consideration

Sincerely,

MARK S. CRITZ
Member of Congress

MSC:ck